

we can't run Android apps on Windows, can we? Well, we couldn't then. All she did then was ask why? And the rest, as they say, is history. The gaming community at large is forever thankful for what they've done!

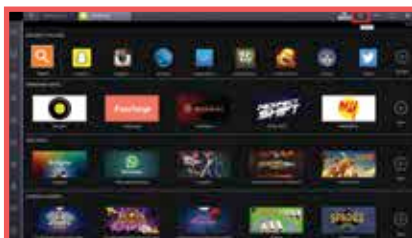
Using BlueStacks you have access to a number of things you could do if you had an Android device. You could move files and images between BlueStacks and your PC. You could install apps directly from your system onto the BlueStacks App Player. You could set your location and even take screenshots of your apps like one could with an actual Android device. It does a very good job of emulating an Android device on your system.

At first BlueStacks was primarily used for messaging apps like WhatsApp. Back when WhatsApp first came out on the scene, not everyone had a phone which could run it, so many resorted to alternative means to use WhatsApp. All the cool kids had WhatsApp so naturally, we wanted to use it too. BlueStacks was one such means. Even though it did not offer the mobility of a phone, just simply being able to use WhatsApp was good enough. Furthermore, it's much easier to use a keyboard to type out messages rather than a phone keypad which can be small and frustrating to use. People would rather not have to deal with auto correct. However, as more and more people began to get smartphones, apps like WhatsApp took the back bench. A new problem emerged, mobile games were beginning to look pretty damn good. While that in itself is not a problem, the problem was that not all phones were powerful enough to be able to support the game or be able to run it smoothly. Various problems from phones heating up to battery life draining at rapid speeds became common, and powerful phones can be quite expensive so not everyone can afford one. Once again, people turned to BlueStacks.

BlueStacks is great for gaming. There's no doubt now that there are some great and addictive mobile games out there which are worth trying out. With the BlueStacks App Player you can



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install and play these games on your PC as though it were your phone. Since systems are far more powerful than phones, they usually don't have any problems handling the games. In fact, after having played a few games using the BlueStacks player, we found it hard to go back to playing them on our mobile devices as it felt far more laggy and slower in comparison.

Playing games on BlueStacks allows for a completely different gaming experience, with much larger resolutions and easy-to-use controls. Using the mouse allows for far more precision while gaming than when using your finger. One could argue that a stylus gives you the

same precision but not every phone comes with or supports a stylus. Additionally you could adjust the shape and size of your app as you pleased, including playing the game at fullscreen. You no longer needed to deal with tiny screens and small text, and since internet connections are also more reliable on PCs using cables, game lag was also significantly reduced since it no longer relied on signal strength. BlueStacks also supports games which use motion sensors and require you to shake or tilt the phone. It has something called accelerometer support, with which you can emulate tilt motions on your app using arrow keys or whatever keys you choose to map it to. While there are definitely many advantages there are few cons as well. Take the latest craze for example, Pokemon Go. You can't exactly walk around or travel with your PC in tow, so you might just have to stick to a mobile device to play it, unless they come up with something of course, here's hoping. Until then BlueStacks is still a great alternative for playing Android games which don't require you to physically move around too much.

Another neat feature that BlueStacks has is it lets you stream your gameplay, your app gameplay that is, directly to Twitch. We can already see that games like Minecraft and Hearthstone are extremely big on Twitch. Livestreaming itself has blown up in the recent years and has become huge throughout the world, much like mobile gaming. With BlueStacks not only can you watch livestreams, but you can directly stream what you're playing on to Twitch as well. Another cool thing is a lot of old time classic games are being ported to mobile devices, take Star Wars Knights of the Old Republic for example. It's a great way to relive those classics as well if you feel like your mobile device can't handle them, just play them on BlueStacks. You can buy apps and make in-app purchases through BlueStacks as well.

When it comes to emulating Android games on PC, BlueStacks has no competition. So give it a try and tell us what you think about it. *